

Browsing through history

To find all commands that involve a certain string, simply pipe it to *grep*.

```
history | grep cd
```

```
[bash]$ history | grep cd
```

```
3 cd Documents/
```

If you wish to view the history one page at a time, you can use the command below. Now, you can simply use the space bar to view one page at a time or use the down arrow to view one line at a time:

```
history | less
```

To view just the last 10 commands, you can use the following:

```
history | tail
```

tail when used with a *-n* option displays only the last *n* lines.

```
[bash]$ history | tail -5
```

```
29 man tail
```

```
30 man grep
```

```
31 nautilus
```

```
32 history | less
```

```
33 history | tail -5
```

History command line options

```
[bash]$ history
```

```
1 pwd
```

```
2 ls
```

```
3 cd Documents/
```

```
4 ll
```

```
5 nautilus
```

```
6 history
```

-c

The above code clears the history log.
syntax: *history -c*

```
[bash]$ history
```

```
[bash]$
```

-d -d offset

The code above deletes the history entry at position offset.
syntax: *history -d 5* (*Deletes the entry at position 5*)

```
[bash]$ history
```

```
1 pwd
```

```
2 ls
```

```
3 cd Documents/
```

```
4 ll
```

```
5 history
```

-a

The above code appends the new history lines (entries in the current session) to the history file.
syntax: *history -a*

-r

The command line given above reads the current history file.
syntax: *history -r*

-w

The above command line writes out the current history to the specified file. This option is useful to export the contents of the history file.

syntax: *history -w alternate_histfile.txt*

-s

The arguments are added to the end of the history list as a single entry, as follows.

syntax: *history -s argument*. 

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